North Quay Survey: Annual Report

Summary

The north quay survey ran for its third full year. Visits rose, the new ladder held up through two storms, and the volunteer rota covered every weekend but one. This report sets out what was measured, what went wrong, and what the board is asked to approve for the coming season.

Visits and rota

Volunteers logged four hundred and twelve visits, up from three hundred and sixty the year before. Most of the growth came on weekday evenings after the lighting was repaired in April. The rota relied on a core of nine people; two of them carried almost a third of all shifts, which the board should treat as a risk rather than a strength.

The one missed weekend fell in August, when three volunteers were away at once and the standby list had not been kept up to date. A shared calendar with a named standby for each month would have caught the gap a fortnight in advance.

Equipment

The ladder installed last spring came through the October and January storms without damage. The older railing on the east steps did not: two posts worked loose and were tied off until the council crew could replace them. The tide board was repainted in June and remains easy to read from the car park. The logbook box leaked twice and its contents were dried out by hand both times, so a new sealed box is part of this year's request.

The survey's two pressure loggers were swapped in rotation every month and cleaned before each deployment. Neither unit failed. Their records agree with the paper log to within a few centimetres on every day both were read, which is better than the survey needs for its own purposes and good enough to share with the harbour office.

Money

Spending stayed inside the agreed budget. The largest single cost was the ladder, paid in the previous year and now fully depreciated in the accounts. Paint, rope and the replacement logbook pages came to a little under the allowance for consumables, and the small surplus is carried forward rather than returned.

Requests to the board

The survey asks the board to approve a sealed logbook box, a shared rota calendar with a named monthly standby, and a modest training evening in March so that newer

volunteers can read the tide board and the loggers without help. None of these needs new money beyond the surplus already carried forward.

The survey also asks the board to raise the east railing with the council again before the autumn storms, since the temporary ties will not last another winter on their own.